

Beef and Vegetable Stew (Variation 17)

Tags: *stew, beef, dinner, comfort-food, winter* | Prep: 25 min | Cook: 150 min | Serves: 12

Ingredients

- 2.4 kg beef chuck, cut into 4 cm cubes
- 6 tbsp all-purpose flour
- Salt and black pepper
- 6 tbsp olive oil
- 2 large onion, diced
- 8 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 tbsp tomato paste
- 500 ml red wine
- 1400 ml beef stock
- 4 bay leaves
- 6 sprigs fresh marjoram
- 8 medium carrots, cut into chunks
- 8 medium potatoes, cut into chunks
- 4 parsnips, cut into chunks
- 2 cup frozen peas
- fresh cilantro to serve

Method

1. Toss beef cubes in flour seasoned generously with salt and pepper until evenly coated.
2. Heat 2 tbsp oil in a large heavy casserole over high heat. Brown beef in batches (do not crowd the pan) for 4–5 minutes per batch until deeply browned on all sides. Remove and set aside.
3. Reduce heat to medium. Add remaining oil, then onion. Cook for 5 minutes until softened.
4. Add garlic and tomato paste; cook for 2 minutes, stirring.
5. Pour in red wine and scrape the bottom of the pot to release all browned bits. Boil for 2 minutes.
6. Return beef to the pot. Add stock, bay leaves, and thyme. The liquid should just cover the beef.
7. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a very gentle simmer. Cover and cook for 1 hour.
8. Add carrots, potatoes, and parsnips. Replace lid and simmer for a further 45–60 minutes until beef is tender.
9. Stir in peas and cook for 5 minutes. Discard bay leaves and thyme.
10. Taste, adjust seasoning, and serve scattered with fresh parsley.

Chef Tips

- Browning the beef in batches is non-negotiable — overcrowding causes steaming not searing.
- The stew improves overnight as flavours meld; reheat gently on the stovetop.
- For a thicker stew, remove the lid for the last 30 minutes of cooking.